

## WEEKLY CA – 13<sup>th</sup> June – 19<sup>th</sup> June

### 1. The theme of Global Wind Day 2026 is:

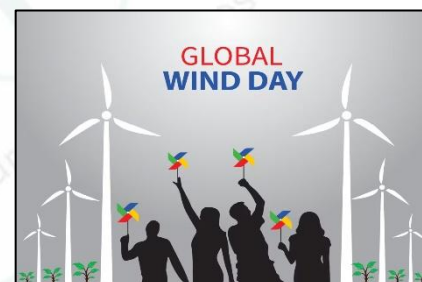
ग्लोबल विंड डे 2026 की थीम है:

- (a) Powering a Sustainable Future
- (b) Wind for a Greener Planet
- (c) Clean Energy for All
- (d) Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration

Answer: (d)

### 15 June - World Wind Day

- Every year on 15 June, the world unites to celebrate World Wind Day—a **day dedicated to discovering the power of wind and the transformative role it plays in reshaping global energy systems.**
- **Theme:** "Wind Energy: From Ambition to Acceleration."
- The history of Global Wind Day dates back to 2007, when it was **first organised by the European Wind Energy Association (EWEA).**
- It became a worldwide event **in 2009** with the support of the Global Wind Energy Council (GWEC).
- India will host the Global Wind Day 2026 Conference on 15 June 2026 in Goa.



| Date    | Day                                                                  | Theme                                                                                             |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 13 June | International Albinism Awareness Day                                 | Proudly in my skin — celebrating all skin tones                                                   |
| 14 June | World Blood Donor Day [WHO]                                          | One Drop of Humanity. Give Blood. Save Lives                                                      |
| 16 June | International Day of Family Remittances                              | Remittances for Rural Resilience, Entrepreneurship and Employment                                 |
| 16 June | World Sea Turtle Day                                                 |                                                                                                   |
| 17 JUNE | World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought                      | Rangelands: Recognize. Respect. Restore.                                                          |
| 17 June | World Crocodile Day                                                  |                                                                                                   |
| 18 June | Sustainable Gastronomy Day                                           | Celebrating Food Heritage                                                                         |
| 18 June | International Day for Countering Hate                                | The power of partnerships in countering speech                                                    |
| 19 June | International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict | Conflict-Related Sexual Violence Against Children: Safeguarding Futures and Empowering Caregivers |
| 19 June | World Sickle Cell Awareness Day                                      | Closing the Survival Gap: Equity in Sickle Cell Disease                                           |

### 2. Zardalu (Jardalu) mango is primarily associated with which state?

जर्दालू (जर्दालू) आम मुख्यतः किस राज्य से सम्बंधित है?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Bihar
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) West Bengal

Answer: (b)

### Zardalu Mangoes

- Every summer, more than 125 quintals of Bhagalpur's famed Zardalu mangoes are carefully selected, packed and dispatched to the President, the Prime Minister, and other top dignitaries, turning a regional fruit into a symbol of Bihar's agricultural heritage.

**Zardalu mango, also called Jardalu, is a unique mango variety from Bhagalpur, Bihar.**

- It is known for its light yellow skin and distinct special aroma.
- Its story dates back to the early 19th century when Maharaja Rahmat Ali Khan Bahadur of Haveli Kharagpur introduced its cultivation in the Bhagalpur region.
- The first sapling, planted between 1810 and 1820, still stands in Tagepur village, serving as a living testament to this mango's enduring legacy.
- The **Jardaloo mangoes are available from mid-April through the end of June.**
- As the fruit matures, the skin of the Zardalu mango turns golden-yellow with a tinge of red across the top of the fruit.
- Jardalu mangoes are rich with fibre & enzymes; it's highly beneficial to the digestive system.

**In 2018, the Jardalu mango received the prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) tag.**

### 3. American novelist Virginia Evans won the Women's Prize 2026 for Fiction for which novel?

अमेरिकी उपन्यासकार वर्जीनिया इवांस ने किस उपन्यास के लिए फिक्शन के लिए महिला पुरस्कार 2026 जीता?

- (a) The Silent Patient
- (b) The Correspondent
- (c) Yellowface
- (d) The Covenant of Water

Answer: (b)

### Virginia Evans and Lyse Doucet win Women's Prize 2026

- **American novelist Virginia Evans won the Women's Prize 2026 for Fiction with : The Correspondent, bestseller that made her a literary star after seven unpublished novels.**
- **Canadian journalist Lyse Doucet won the Women's Prize for Nonfiction with : The Finest Hotel in Kabul: A People's History of Afghanistan.**
- Both prizes come with a GBP 30,000 (\$40,000) purse and are open to female English-language writers from any country.



### 4. Who has been appointed as the new Chairperson of the National Statistical Commission (NSC)?

राष्ट्रीय सांख्यिकी आयोग (NSC) के नए अध्यक्ष के रूप में किसे नियुक्त किया गया है?

- A. Dr. Madhavan Mukund
- B. Prof. Shubhabrata Das
- C. Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay
- D. Satyendra Bahadur Singh

Answer: C

### National Statistical Commission

- Recently, the Government of India has appointed a new Chairperson and three Members to the National Statistical Commission.

- **The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved the appointment of the Chairman and Members of the National Statistical Commission as follows:**
- Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay, Chairperson
- Prof. Shubhabrata Das, Member
- Shri Satyendra Bahadur Singh, Member
- Dr. Madhavan Mukund, Member

#### About National Statistical Commission

- It was set up in **2005** on the recommendations of Rangarajan Commission (2000).
- **It was established to serve as a nodal body for all core statistical activities of the country and also evolve, monitor and enforce statistical priorities and standards and to ensure statistical co-ordination.**

#### Composition

- It consists of a part-time Chairperson, four part-time Members having specialization and experience in areas of statistics,
- **CEO of NITI Aayog as an ex-officio Member.**
- The Chief Statistician of India is the Secretary of the Commission. (He is also the Secretary to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation).

#### 5. Sacred Unions and Other Stories is authored by:

'सेक्रेड यूनियंस एंड अदर स्टोरीज़' के लेखक हैं:

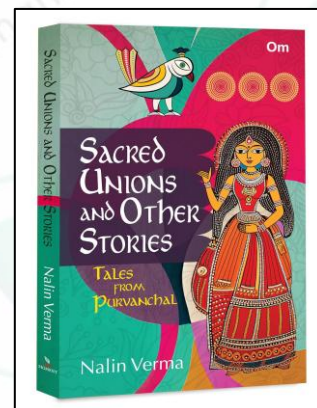
- (a) Amitav Ghosh
- (b) Nalin Verma
- (c) Ruskin Bond
- (d) Vikram Seth

**Answer:** (b)

**How Nalin Verma is preserving the soul of purvanchal through love, memory and folklore**

**Sacred Unions and Other Stories is an anthology of five tales,**

- **By - Nalin Verma**
- Preserves the fading cultural soul of the Purvanchal region (covering eastern Uttar Pradesh and rural Bihar) **by converting oral traditions, local myths, and grassroots memories into evocative English literature**
- his prominent works, includes - The Greatest Folk Tales of Bihar (2019), Lores of Love & Saint Gorakhnath (2025), and his latest fiction anthology.



#### 6. Consider the following statements regarding the "Dancing Girl" of Mohenjo-daro:

The terracotta figurine belongs to the Indus Valley Civilization.

It is approximately 10.8 cm tall.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

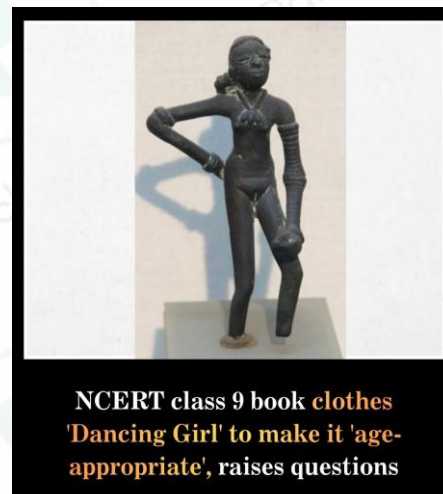
- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2



Answer: b

### Revisiting the 'Dancing Girl': The Harappan bronze figurine and its NCERT representation

- The iconic "Dancing Girl" of Mohenjo Daro, a 4,500-year-old bronze figurine that has featured in Indian school textbooks for decades, appears to have been altered in a newly released Class 9 art education textbook published by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT).
- **The "Dancing Girl" was one of two bronze female figurines found at Mohenjo-Daro**, discovered in a small house in the south-western quarter of the city during the 1926–27 excavations.
- The 10.8 cm figurine depicts a slender woman standing with **her right hand on the back of her hip** and her left hand resting on her left thigh, just above the knee.
- **Craftsmanship:** The figurine was created using the Lost-Wax Casting Technique, a sophisticated metallurgical process.
- **Lost-wax casting is a process where a wax model is covered with a heat-resistant mold, the wax is melted out, molten metal is poured into the hollow cavity, and once it cools, the mold is removed to reveal the metal object.**
- **Artistic Significance:** The sculpture shows a young girl in a confident pose with tilted head and long arms, combining realism with stylized exaggeration.
- Her posture and ornaments convey grace and rhythm, earning her the name "Dancing Girl."



### 7. WT-MARUT is India's first dedicated digital platform for:

WT-MARUT भारत का पहला समर्पित डिजिटल प्लेटफॉर्म है, जो इनके लिए है:

- (a) Monitoring solar parks
- (b) Managing the wind turbine manufacturing supply chain
- (c) Trading renewable energy certificates
- (d) Offshore oil exploration

Answer: (b)

### Wind Turbine Supply Chain Management Portal (WT-MARUT)

- **Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy officially launched India's first dedicated wind turbine supply chain management portal, WT-MARUT, at the Global Wind Day Conference in Goa.**
- WT-MARUT is India's first indigenous, centralized digital platform **explicitly dedicated to managing, tracking, and optimizing the domestic wind turbine manufacturing supply chain ecosystem.**
- **Ministry:** Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)
- **Aim:** The aim of WT-MARUT is to strengthen India's domestic wind manufacturing capabilities and drive inclusion across the supply chain.

### 8. Sundarraj Pattilingam, recently in the news, has been appointed as:

हाल ही में खबरों में रहे सुंदरराज पट्टिलिंगम को इस पद पर नियुक्त किया गया है:

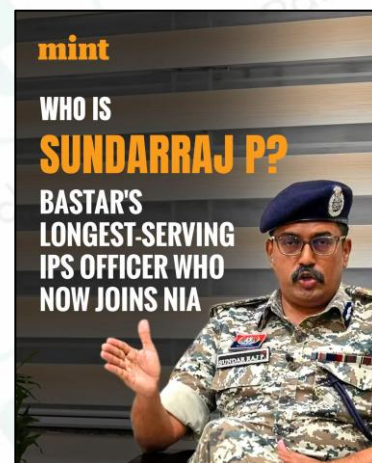
- A. Director of CBI
- B. Director General of CRPF

- C. Inspector General of NIA  
D. National Security Adviser

Answer: C.

#### Sundarraaj Pattilingam Appointed NIA Inspector General

- Indian Police Service (IPS) officer Sundarraaj Pattilingam, who spearheaded the anti-Maoist operations in Chhattisgarh's Bastar, the erstwhile Left-wing insurgent stronghold, has been appointed National Investigation Agency (NIA) inspector general (IG) nearly three months after the government declared India Maoist-free.
- Pattilingam, 46, a 2003 batch IPS officer, served for 12 years in Bastar, where the banned Communist Party of India (Maoist)'s central guerrilla arm was headquartered



#### 9. With reference to the Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026, consider the following statements:

Russia is ranked as the least peaceful country in the world.

The Global Peace Index is published by the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP).

India is ranked 127th among 163 countries.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only  
(b) 2 and 3 only  
(c) 1 and 3 only  
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

#### 2026 Global Peace Index (GPI)

Every year, the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP) releases the Global Peace Index (GPI).

- It ranks the 163 countries based on their safety and peace parameters, which are set by IEP.
- The **2026 data is the 20th edition** of the index that has been released, and **Iceland remains in the first rank as the safest country in the world in 2026.**
- The Global Peace Index is published by the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP). **It measures peace using 23 different factors. These factors are grouped into three areas, which are:**
  - Societal safety and security (crime rate, fear of violence, homicide rate)
  - Ongoing domestic and international conflict (wars, armed conflicts)
  - Militarisation (military spending, weapons imports)
- Countries with lower GPI scores are considered more peaceful.** The index covers 99.7% of the world's population.



**Key Highlights of the 2026 GPI**

- Global peace has declined for the 12th year in a row.
- **Out of 163 countries, 99 became less peaceful in the past year.**
- There are now 61 active state-based conflicts in the world, the highest since World War II.
- **Russia is ranked as the least peaceful country.**
- Iceland holds the top spot as the most peaceful country for the 19th year in a row.
- **India holds the 127th rank among the 163 countries with a score of 2.409 in GPI 2026, which is down by 3 rankings compared to last year, 2025.**

| Rank | Country     | Score |
|------|-------------|-------|
| 1    | Iceland     | 1.161 |
| 2    | New Zealand | 1.343 |
| 3    | Switzerland | 1.363 |
| 4    | Slovenia    | 1.369 |
| 5    | Ireland     | 1.371 |

**10. Which district is set to become the first in Uttar Pradesh where all gram panchayats would be declared child labour-free?**

कौन सा जिला उत्तर प्रदेश का पहला जिला बनने जा रहा है जहां सभी ग्राम पंचायतों को बाल श्रम मुक्त घोषित किया जाएगा?

- (a) Jhansi  
(b) Prayagraj  
(c) Kanpur  
(d) Gorakhpur

Answer: (a)

**Jhansi first UP district with 'no child labour in its 496 villages'**

- **In line with Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's announcement to make Uttar Pradesh child labour-free by 2027, Jhansi is set to become the first district of the state** where all 496 of its gram panchayats would be declared child labour-free.
- **'Child labour-free' status does not imply that every household in the district was physically inspected.** Rather, it means that all identified child labourers were withdrawn from work, enrolled in schools, and their families linked with welfare schemes.

**A working child under the age of 14 years is considered a child labour as per Indian laws.**

**11. Recently, which of the following traditional products from Bihar received the Geographical Indication (GI) Tag?**

- Bawan Buti Saree and Fabric  
Patharkatti Stone Craft  
Pidiya Painting

**Select the correct answer using the code below:**

- (a) 1 only



(b) 1 and 2 only

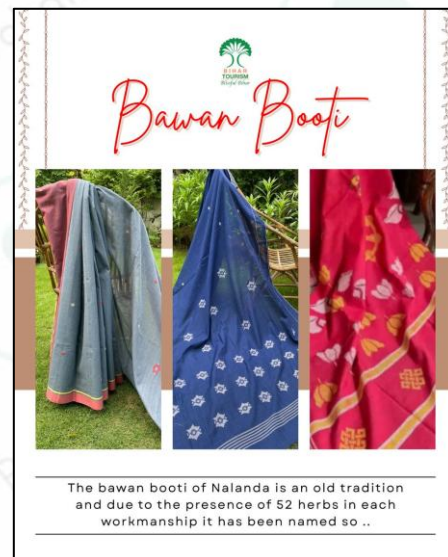
(c) 2 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

### Three Traditional Products of Bihar Receive GI Tag

- **Three traditional products of Bihar — Bawan Buti Saree and Fabric (Nalanda), Patharkatti Stone Craft (Gaya), and Pidiya Painting (Bhojpur) — have been granted the Geographical Indication (GI) Tag**, providing legal recognition and protection to these unique cultural and handicraft traditions.
- **Bawan Buti Saree and Fabric (Nalanda):** This traditional art involves hand-weaving 52 cultural motifs and symbols onto fabric and **has been preserved for generations, mainly in Baswan Bigha and its surrounding areas.**
- **Patharkatti Stone Craft (Gaya):** Gaya's nearly 300-year-old Pattharkatti stone craft is renowned across India for its intricate carvings on local black granite, depicting Lord Buddha, deities, and elements of folk culture.
- **Peedhiya Painting (Bhojpur):** This traditional art, created by women during festivals and special occasions, depicts rural life, family relationships, and religious beliefs through natural colours and traditional symbols.



### 12. Raja Festival is celebrated during the Sun's transition into which zodiac sign?

रज महोत्सव सूर्य के किस राशि में संक्रमण के दौरान मनाया जाता है?

(a) Mesha (Aries)

(b) Vrishabha (Taurus)

(c) Mithuna (Gemini)

(d) Karka (Cancer)

Answer: (c)

### Pahili Raja festival begins in Odisha, marking onset of monsoon and Ashadha month

- In Odisha, the three-day Raja festival began with the celebration of Pahili Raja, ushering in the onset of the monsoon and the Odia month of Ashadha.
- Young girls are marking the occasion by taking traditional baths, wearing new clothes, and adorning themselves with alta on their feet and mehendi on their hands
- Raja swings hung from trees have become centres of celebration as girls sang traditional Raja songs while enjoying the festivities.
- The festival derives its name from **Rajaswala**, reflecting the belief that the earth, like women, undergoes a period of rest and rejuvenation.



### 13. Exercise Pitch Black 2026 is hosted by the air force of which country?

अभ्यास पिच ब्लैक 2026 की मेजबानी किस देश की वायु सेना द्वारा की जाती है?

- (a) Australia
- (b) United Kingdom
- (c) United States
- (d) France

Answer: (a)

#### Exercise Pitch Black

India will participate in Australia's Exercise Pitch Black 2026 from July 20 to August 7 alongside 18 other nations.

- It is a biennial and multinational exercise hosted by the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF).
- It is the RAAF's flagship international flying exercise.
- The name 'Pitch Black' was derived from the emphasis on nighttime flying over large unpopulated areas.
- It will run from July 20 to August 7, 2026, with operations based out of RAAF Bases Darwin and Tindal in the Northern Territory, as well as RAAF Base Amberley in Queensland.
- It features a massive assembly of global air forces, providing an unparalleled platform for interoperability. 19 nations, including India, with 100+ aircraft and 4,400+ personnel are participating in the exercise.
- The IAF has dispatched a highly capable multi-role task force to the exercise, ensuring robust participation across multiple operational spectrum.
- **Previous participation of India:** The IAF has previously participated in the 2018, 2022, and 2024 editions of this exercise..



### 14. 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra' is best described as:

'तिलहन किसान मित्र' का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन इस प्रकार किया गया है:

- (a) A subsidy scheme for oilseed farmers
- (b) A WhatsApp-based AI advisory service for oilseed cultivation
- (c) A crop insurance scheme for oilseed growers



(d) A national mission for edible oil imports

Answer: b

### 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra', India's First Nationwide WhatsApp AI Advisory for Oilseed Farmers

- The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare highlighted the nationwide impact of 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra', India's first WhatsApp-based AI advisory service for oilseed cultivation, as farmers enter the crucial kharif sowing season.
- **Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra is a 24×7, multilingual, AI-powered digital advisory chatbot accessible directly through WhatsApp.**
- It serves as an instant, **free-of-cost scientific consulting gateway that connects traditional farmers with decades of collective agricultural research without requiring them to download external mobile applications or use complex internet browsers.**
- **Developed By:** The digital platform was developed by the ICAR-Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad.
- **How to Access and How It Works?**

**The platform simplifies high-tech agricultural extension into three basic user steps:**

- **Step 1:** The farmer saves the official dedicated contact number +91 4024598180 as 'Oilseeds Kisaan Mitra' on their smartphone.
- **Step 2:** The user opens WhatsApp and types, speaks, or sends a crop-related query in their native regional language.
- **Step 3:** The underlying AI engine instantly parses the localized text, matches it against a verified scientific repository, and beams back clear, research-validated advice.

### Key Features of the Platform:

- **Comprehensive Oilseed Coverage:** Provides precise, location-specific advice across all major domestic oilseed groups—including groundnut, mustard, sesame, sunflower, soybean, and niger.
- **Full Multilingual Integration:** Features a natural language processing architecture that understands and responds instantly in all official Indian regional languages (including Hindi, Kannada, Gujarati, Telugu, and Malayalam).

### 15. Which organization recently granted Final Operational Clearance (FOC) to the indigenous Netra AEW&C system?

हाल ही में किस संगठन ने स्वदेशी नेत्रा AEW&C प्रणाली को अंतिम परिचालन मंजूरी (FOC) प्रदान की है?

- (a) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (b) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- (c) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- (d) Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

Answer: (a)

### Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) system

- **The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has granted Final Operational Clearance (FOC) to the indigenous Netra Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) system.**
- Commonly known as the Indian Air Force's (IAF) "Eye in the Sky," Netra is India's first indigenously developed **airborne surveillance, command-and-control, and battle management platform.**
- It functions as a **highly mobile, flying radar station** that scans vast areas of airspace far beyond the limits of conventional ground-based radar systems.

**16. With reference to the Masroor Rock-Cut Temples, consider the following statements:**

They exhibit the North Indian Nagara style of architecture.

The temple complex follows a symmetrically laid-out square grid.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

**Masroor Rock-Cut Temples**

- Tucked away in the hills of **Himachal Pradesh's Kangra Valley** lies **Masroor Rock-Cut Temples**, an extraordinary piece of Indian heritage that is mostly ignored.
- Masroor Rock-Cut Temples, also referred to as **Masroor Temples**, is an early 8th-century complex of **rock-cut Hindu temples in the Kangra Valley of the Beas River in Himachal Pradesh**.
- They are often referred to as the **Ellora of Himachal and the Himalayan pyramid**
- Archaeological surveys say that they have been built around the 8th century — almost 1200 years ago — due to **their resemblance to the "Gupta style of architecture" from the same period**.
- However, there is no mention of the temple in any of the scriptures or historical records.
- **The temple complex was first reported by Henry Shuttleworth in 1913**, bringing it to the attention of archaeologists.

**Architecture**

- The 15-monument temple complex resembles the **North Indian Nagara architecture style** and is dedicated to Lord Shiva, Lord Ram, Goddess Sita, and Lord Lakshmana.

**The temples were carved out of monolithic rock with a shikhara and provided with a sacred pool of water.**

**17. Which of the following is the most famous song associated with the Maand style of singing?**

निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा गायन की मांड शैली से जुड़ा सबसे प्रसिद्ध गीत है?

- (a) Nimbooda Nimbooda
- (b) Kesariya Baalam
- (c) Ghoomar
- (d) Padharo Mhare Des

Answer: (b)

**Gavri Devi, Rajasthani Mand Singer, Dies at 98**

**Renowned 'Maand' singer from Rajasthan, Gavri Devi, 98, passed away at her residence in Pali, Rajasthan**

- Gavri Devi remained active in the field of Maand singing for nearly eight decades
- **The most recalled song in the Maand style is the ever popular 'Kesariya Baalam'.**



- Gavri Devi was born in Koran village, Barmer district.
- **Her programmes were broadcast on Doordarshan and All India Radio.** During her lifetime, she received honors from the Jawahar Kala Kendra and Doordarshan, as well as the Veer Durgadas Rathore Lifetime Achievement Award.

**18. SHAN Conservation Society, recently seen in the news, is primarily associated with the conservation of:**

SHAN कंजर्वेशन सोसाइटी, जो हाल ही में समाचारों में देखी गई, मुख्य रूप से किसके संरक्षण से जुड़ी है:

- A. Great Indian Bustard
- B. Snow Leopard
- C. Asiatic Lion
- D. One-Horned Rhinoceros

Answer: B

**SHAN Conservation Society to protect snow leopards in Ladakh**

- **Ladakh Lt Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on approved the constitution of first-of-its-kind 'Snow Leopard and High-Altitude Nature' (SHAN) Conservation Society, which will act as a dedicated institutional mechanism for wildlife conservation and community-led environmental stewardship in the Union Territory.**
- The LG of Ladakh will be the chairman of the society, while the chief secretary, Ladakh MP, chief executive councillor, LAHDC, Leh, the chief executive councillor, LAHDC, Kargil, and the principal secretary, Department of Forest, Ecology and Environment, will be the ex-officio members.
- The society will promote, assist and mobilise resources for the conservation of wildlife and their habitat, eco-development in the vicinity of areas inhabited by snow leopard, its co-existing species, and promote eco-tourism and sustainable livelihood,
- **Revered as the 'Ghost of the Mountains', the snow leopard is a keystone species whose presence reflects the health of the entire Trans-Himalayan ecosystem.**
- The snow leopard (*Panthera uncia*) is currently classified as **Vulnerable on the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species.**

**19. Which university secured the 1st position globally in the QS World University Rankings 2027?**

QS वर्ल्ड यूनिवर्सिटी रैंकिंग 2027 में किस विश्वविद्यालय ने विश्व स्तर पर प्रथम स्थान प्राप्त किया?

- A. Harvard University
- B. University of Oxford
- C. Stanford University
- D. Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Answer: D.

**QS World University Rankings 2027 Released**

- The QS World University Rankings 2027 were released on June 18, 2026, **with the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) taking the top spot globally for the 15th consecutive year.**

**Global Top 5 Universities**

- Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (United States)





- Imperial College London (United Kingdom) / Stanford University (United States) (Tied for 2nd)

### University of Oxford (United Kingdom)

- Harvard University
- A total of 52 Indian institutions made the top 1500 list, with 13 Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs) representing a large chunk of the country's highest performers.
- IIT Delhi secured the top spot among Indian universities, rising to 118th globally.
- IIT Bombay ranked 134th globally.
- IIT Madras climbed to 170th globally.



## 20. The Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Yojana has been launched by which state government?

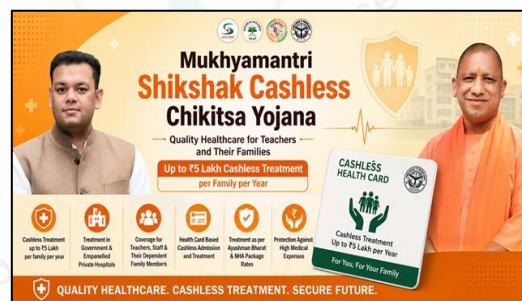
मुख्यमंत्री शिक्षक कैशलेस चिकित्सा योजना किस राज्य सरकार द्वारा शुरू की गई है?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Uttar Pradesh
- (d) Haryana

Answer: (c)

### Uttar Pradesh Launches Teacher Cashless Health Scheme Portal

- The Uttar Pradesh government is in the final stages of launching the Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Yojana, **under which teachers, education department employees and their dependent family members will be eligible for cashless medical treatment of up to Rs 5 lakh annually.**
- Under the programme, beneficiaries will receive treatment at empanelled government and private hospitals using a Mukhyamantri Shikshak Cashless Chikitsa Card.
- Medical expenses up to the prescribed limit will be covered under the scheme, reducing the financial burden on families during serious illnesses and medical emergencies.**



## 21. The Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam Project is being constructed across which river?

किशाऊ बहुउद्देशीय बांध परियोजना किस नदी पर बनाई जा रही है?

- A. Ganga
- B. Yamuna
- C. Tons
- D. Chambal

Answer: C

### The Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam

- **Union Home Minister chaired a crucial meeting in New Delhi where a historic consensus was reached among six stakeholder states to implement the long-pending Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam Project.**
- The six states of Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Haryana, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan agreed to sign a memorandum of understanding (MoU)
- **The Kishau Multi-Purpose Dam Project is a large-scale, under-construction water infrastructure and hydro-power development venture.**
- It has been designated as a project of national importance aimed at resolving inter-state water sharing issues, generating clean energy, and rejuvenating regional river ecosystems.
- **River and Site:** The dam is being constructed across the **Tons River, a primary tributary of the Yamuna River.**
- It is situated roughly 39 km (24 mi) north of Dakpathar and upstream of the existing Ichari Dam.

### Key Features of the Project:

- **Engineering Specifications:** The design features a massive 236-meter-high concrete gravity dam backed by an estimated financial investment of ₹11,500 crore.

**The structure will create a massive reservoir holding 1,324 Million Cubic Meters (MCM) of live water storage capacity.**

- **Power and Energy Generation:** The dam houses a hydroelectric power plant rated at 660 Megawatts (MW), which is projected to generate 1,379 Million Units (MU) of clean electricity annually.
- **The 90:10 Funding Framework:** Under the newly brokered agreement, the Central Government will fund 90 percent of the project's water component as a national financial assistance grant, while the six stakeholder states will split the remaining 10 percent.
- **Timeline:** Initially approved by the Ministry of Environment and Forests in 2018 after years of negotiation delays, the project is currently scheduled for full completion by 2028.

### 22. Which company unveiled the Simha 4x4 ?

किस कंपनी ने सिम्हा 4x4 का अनावरण किया?

- Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
- Kalyani Strategic Systems Limited (KSSL)
- Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)

Answer: C.

### Bharat Forge Unveils Simha 4x4 Armoured Vehicle

- **The wholly-owned defence subsidiary of Bharat Forge Limited, Kalyani Strategic Systems Limited (KSSL), unveiled a new light armoured vehicle, the Simha 4x4, a next-generation Light Armoured Multi-Purpose Vehicle at Eurosatory 2026, the international defence and security exhibition being held in Paris.**





- The newly launched platform has been developed to cater to modern battlefield requirements and is designed to offer enhanced mobility, protection and mission flexibility across a range of defence and security operations.

### 23. Which international organization is assisting the REWARD Programme?

कौन सा अंतर्राष्ट्रीय संगठन रिवॉर्ड कार्यक्रम में सहायता कर रहा है?

- A. Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- B. International Monetary Fund (IMF)
- C. Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)
- D. World Bank

Answer: D

#### REWARD Program

- The **National Rainfed Area Authority (NRAA) organized a meeting** on the draft National Technical Guidelines (NTG) for Improved Watershed Management under the Rejuvenating Watersheds for Agricultural Resilience through Innovative Development (REWARD) Programme.
- **REWARD (Rejuvenating Watersheds for Agricultural Resilience through Innovative Development) program is a watershed development program which is being implemented in the States of Karnataka and Odisha.**
- **Time Period:** 2021 to 2026
- The **program aims to introduce modern watershed practices in the Department of Land Resources and in the States of Karnataka and Odisha.**
- It is **assisted by the World Bank.**
- The REWARD program works on a **financial instrument called "PforR" (Program for Results)** which means the World Bank will reimburse the loan amount against the achievement of Disbursement Linked Indicators (DLIs).
- **Objective of REWARD:** To strengthen capacities of national and state institutions to adopt improved watershed management for increasing farmers' resilience and support value chains in selected watersheds of participating States".

### 24. 'Varya', recently launched in India, is best described as:

हाल ही में भारत में लॉन्च हुए 'वार्या' (Varya) को सबसे अच्छे तरीके से इस तरह बताया जा सकता है:

- (a) A large language model for coding
- (b) An AI-powered video generation model
- (c) A satellite imaging platform
- (d) A digital payment system

Answer: (b)

- **India AI Mission launches Indigenous Varya, a Video Story Generating AI Model Claiming to Offer Quality at Affordable Price**
- Avataar, an AI-native transformation company, announced the launch of Varya, a **distilled video model built to make frontier video AI affordable, accessible and relevant for India's next generation of users.**
- Varya has been designed for India's many contexts, not a generalized idea of India.





- **The model has been built to understand and generate culturally rich visual outputs across India's regions, festivals, communities, food, clothing, public spaces and everyday life.**
- **Avataar was among the companies selected by the IndiaAI Mission to build indigenous foundation AI capabilities.**
- Developed with support from the IndiaAI Mission, Varya uses a **distillation technique that reduces video generation from 50 steps to 4 steps**, while maintaining comparable output quality.
- Varya can generate video at ₹0.48 per second, making it upto 10x more cost-efficient than several leading global video models.
- **The product experience is designed around a simple promise: Idea → Video → Story.**

## 25. Which of the following is the most famous theme depicted in Jadopatia Paintings?

जादोपतिया पेंटिंग में दर्शाया गया सबसे प्रसिद्ध विषय निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा है?

- (a) Folk tales of tribal heroes
- (b) Tribal hunting traditions
- (c) Life after death among the Santhals
- (d) Mughal court scenes

Answer: (c)

## Jharkhand Gets GI Tags for 11 Traditional Products

### Bhagaiya silk

- It is a hand spun silk textile **mainly woven by Santhal tribal women.**
- These silk varieties, deeply rooted in local knowledge systems and indigenous craftsmanship, represent generations of skill passed down within rural communities



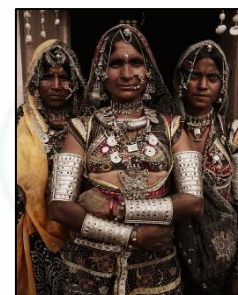
### Kuchai silk

- It is **produced by tussar silkworms cultivated on the trees of Asan and Arjun.**
- It is a part of ancient tradition of Jharkhand, which provides livelihood in rural areas.
- It was started in the small village of Seraikela-Kharsawan – 'Kuchai' and is now spread all over Jharkhand.



### Munda Jewellery

- It is the distinctive artistic tradition of the Munda tribal community.
- It is **characterised by its unique motifs**, craftsmanship and cultural significance, the jewellery embodies the rich tribal heritage of Jharkhand.



### Jharkhand bamboo craft

- This product is **made from locally available bamboo and will now be accessible to a wider market.**
- It involves creativity and craftsmanship of rural artisans who transform locally available bamboo resources into a wide range of utility and decorative products.



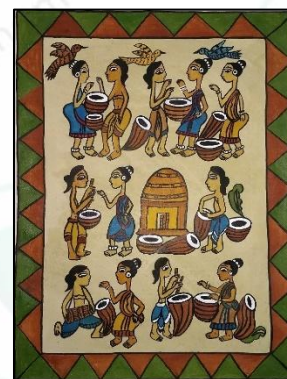
- **Kesaria Kalakand** : The sweet is native to the Koderma district , **Recognized for its rich texture and distinct traditional preparation, Concentrated milk (khoa), sugar, alum, garnished with kesar (saffron), almonds, and pistachios.**



- **Dokra Craft** : It utilizes the "Lost-Wax Casting" (Cire Perdue) method. This non-ferrous metal technique combines clay molding with thin beeswax wires.
- **Tumka Chadar**: The textile is deep-rooted in the cultural heritage of the Dumka district (Santhal Pargana region)



- **Jadopatia Painting**: The Name: Derived from Jadu (magic painter) and Patia (scroll). **The themes of the paintings are stories from Ramayana and Mahabharata, festivals and other rituals.** But the most famous and important theme is life after death of man (of the Santhal).



- **Pancho Saree and Fabric**: It is worn predominantly by tribal women during festivals, weddings, and socio-cultural ceremonies
- **Tussar Silk and Sarees**: Known for its rich, coarse texture and natural golden-beige sheen, the semi-wild silk is woven by rural tribal communities. Tussar comes from Antheraea mylitta silkworms that feed on wild Sal, Arjun, and Asan trees.



## 26. "Operation Tiger" is associated with the politics of which state?

"ऑपरेशन टाइगर" किस राज्य की राजनीति से संबंधित है?

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) Telangana

Answer: (b)

### Amid 'Operation Tiger' buzz

- **"Operation Tiger" is the codename for an alleged political maneuver by Maharashtra Chief Minister Eknath Shinde's faction to engineer a split within Uddhav Thackeray's Shiv Sena (UBT).**
- The operation reportedly aims to lure several Lok Sabha Members of Parliament (MPs) away from Thackeray's camp to join the ruling alliance

## 27. What is the Mombasa Declaration?

मोम्बासा घोषणा क्या है?

- A. An agreement to promote sustainable tourism in coastal regions
- B. A treaty on marine biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction
- C. A global framework for ocean-based renewable energy
- D. An international declaration to strengthen fisheries transparency and curb IUU fishing

Answer: D

### Mombasa Declaration

- **15 Fifteen countries from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Caribbean, and the Pacific recently adopted the Mombasa Declaration to step up efforts to combat illegal fishing.**
- It was adopted by 15 countries from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Caribbean, and the Pacific to step up efforts to combat illegal fishing.
- It calls on governments to improve access to information on fishing vessels, ownership, and licensing, and to strengthen data sharing to better track fishing activities and enforce regulations.
- It is **named after the Kenyan city hosting the 11th Our Ocean Conference (OOC).**
- **Out of the more than 30 countries represented in the summit**, Belgium, Cameroon, Chile, the Dominican Republic, France, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Liberia, Panama, Papua New Guinea, Peru, the Republic of the Congo, Somalia, and South Korea signed the agreement.
- It is **intended to curb illegal, unreported, and unregulated fishing, also known as IUU fishing**, which threatens marine ecosystems and the livelihoods of millions of people who depend on fisheries.
- **The declaration builds support for the Global Charter for Fisheries Transparency**, a set of 10 policy principles aimed at improving governance through low-cost reforms, including modernizing vessel registries and publishing fishing authorizations

#### INDEXBOX

Markets

**15 Governments Sign  
Mombasa Declaration to  
Combat IUU Fishing at Our  
Ocean...**

IndexBox Market Intelligence

### Key Facts about Our Ocean Conference (OOC)

- Launched in 2014 by the U.S. Department of State and former Secretary of State John Kerry, the **OOC is a major international platform that unites governments, businesses, NGOs, and academic institutions to drive ocean-related action and ambition.**



- Since its inception, it has generated over 2,600 commitments valued at more than \$160 billion, making it one of the most impactful global gatherings for ocean sustainability.
- **2026 OCC: Mombasa (Kenya) – Marking the first time the global summit was held on African soil, themed “Our Ocean, Our Heritage, Our Future”.**

## 28. INS Tarkash, recently seen in the news, belongs to which class of warships?

हाल ही में खबरों में रहा आईएनएस तरकश किस श्रेणी के युद्धपोतों से संबंधित है?

- A. Shivalik-class Frigate
- B. Talwar-class Guided Missile Frigate
- C. Kolkata-class Destroyer
- D. Kamorta-class Corvette

Answer: b

### INS Tarkash

- **Indian Naval Ship Tarkash, a stealth frigate of the Indian Navy, recently arrived in Port Victoria, Seychelles, during its ongoing deployment in the South West Indian Ocean Region.**
- It is a state-of-the-art stealth frigate of the Indian Navy.
- It is the **second of three Talwar-class guided missile frigates.**
- Designed and built in Russia, the Talwar-class guided missile frigates are modified version of the Krivak III-class frigate
- It was **built by the Yantar shipyard in Kaliningrad, Russia.**
- **It was commissioned into Indian Navy service on 9 November 2012 at Kaliningrad** and joined the Western Naval Command on 27 December 2012.

### INS Tarkash Features

- Displacing 3,850 tonnes, it has a **length of 124.8 m**, a beam of 15.2 m, and a draught of 4.2 m.
- With **maximum speeds in excess of 30 knots**, a range of 4,500 miles or 30 days and a complement of 253 personnel, the ship is powered by four gas turbines.

**It can board one Ka-28 Helix-A antisubmarine helicopter or one Ka-31 Helix-B airborne early warning helicopter.**

- It carries cutting-edge weaponry, which includes advanced surface-to-air missiles, 100 mm calibre guns (artillery), close-range guns, torpedoes, rocket launchers, and associated fire control systems.
- It is **also equipped with BrahMos missiles instead of the Klub-N missiles, which makes it different from the earlier flight of Talwar-class ships**

## 29. Which institution has developed the arsenic detection device 'ArsenSafe'?

किस संस्थान ने आर्सेनिक का पता लगाने वाला उपकरण 'ArsenSafe' विकसित किया है?

- (a) IIT Delhi
- (b) IIT Kharagpur
- (c) IIT Bhubaneswar
- (d) IIT Guwahati

Answer: (c)



### IIT Bhubaneswar Develops 'ArsenSafe' Portable Device for Detecting Arsenic in Drinking Water

- Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bhubaneswar has innovated a device to detect arsenic that would help improve water quality monitoring and public health.
- The team has developed a compact, portable and hand-held arsenic detection device named 'ArsenSafe' through Nano Semic Private Limited, a start-up incubated at the Research and Entrepreneurship Park, IIT Bhubaneswar.**
- ArsenSafe can accurately detect arsenic without the need for laboratory infrastructure and chemicals, making water-quality assessment faster and more accessible.
- Researchers said it was designed for rapid, cost-effective and on-site testing.



### 30. LCA-625, recently in the news, has been developed primarily for the production of:

LCA-625, जो हाल ही में खबरों में है, मुख्य रूप से किसके उत्पादन के लिए विकसित किया गया है:

- (a) Turmeric
- (b) Dry chilli
- (c) Bell pepper
- (d) Coriander Seed

Answer: (b)

### Guntur's Lam Farm releases two chilli varieties to rival Teja and Byadgi

- The Regional Horticultural Research Station (RHRS), Lam Farm, has developed two chilli varieties as alternatives to the popular Teja and Byadgi, with some pest resistance, high pungency and tolerance to weather conditions.**
- Two chilli varieties — LCA-625 and LCA-643**

### LCA-643 is suitable for both green and dry chilli cultivation.

- The variety produces light green fruits measuring 13 to 14 cm in length that turn bright red after drying, resembling the popular Byadgi variety.
- It is tolerant to moisture stress, shows moderate resistance to the Gemini virus** and performs well even under black thrips infestation with minimal pesticide use.
- LCA-625, developed primarily for dry chilli production**, has plants with dense branching and medium-length fruits of 8 to 10 cm, **similar to the Teja variety.**
- The **variety has high pungency** of 45,000 to 50,000 Scoville Heat Units and a red colour value of 60 to 65 ASTA units.
- It is also moderately tolerant to fruit rot disease.

### 31. The BRICS Indore Declaration, adopted in 2026, is primarily related to:

2026 में अपनाया गया ब्रिक्स इंदौर घोषणा मुख्य रूप से संबंधित है:

- (a) MSME development and industrial cooperation
- (b) Defence and security cooperation
- (c) Food security, farmer welfare, climate-resilient agriculture and digital agriculture
- (d) Urban infrastructure financing



Answer: (c)

### BRICS adopts Indore Declaration: What are 4 priorities and 4 new initiatives?

- **India's BRICS Presidency culminated in the adoption of the BRICS Indore Declaration during the Agriculture Ministers' Meeting held in Indore in June 2026.**
- The BRICS Indore Declaration is a unanimous joint agricultural charter adopted by BRICS member countries during the 2026 Agriculture Ministers' Meeting in Indore, Madhya Pradesh.

### India assumed the presidency of the BRICS bloc on January 1, 2026, succeeding Brazil.

- Meanwhile, the **BRICS Urbanisation Forum concluded in Delhi**, that BRICS countries had accepted India's proposal to establish a BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network
- The **BRICS Agriculture Ministers and officials-level meetings held in Indore in which the 'BRICS Indore Declaration' was unanimously adopted to provide new direction to food security, farmer welfare, climate-resilient farming, agricultural trade and digital agriculture.**
- This declaration records a shared commitment to advance food security, nutrition, livelihoods, agricultural trade, innovation, investment, climate-resilient farming, and sustainable agricultural development **with the farmer at its centre.**
- **Four priorities:** The declaration has been adopted amid ongoing geopolitical tensions and focuses on **four main priorities: Farmers, food security, climate and technology.**
- **5. Four Institutional initiatives:** Separately, four institutional initiatives have also been proposed. It includes:

#### (i) Centres of Excellence on Agro-Ecology and Regenerative Agriculture:

- Establishing a BRICS Network of Centres of Excellence on Agro-Ecology and Regenerative **Agriculture will birth a platform for joint research, experience sharing and capacity building on natural, organic and regenerative agricultural practices, through which member countries will learn from each other's best practices** and promote climate-resilient and sustainable agricultural systems.
- **(ii) BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture:** The second major initiative is the BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture, which will give new direction to **cooperation in the fields of artificial intelligence, geospatial technology, digital public infrastructure and data-based agricultural solutions.** IIT Delhi in India will coordinate this network.
- **(iii) Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems:** The third announcement is related to the setting up of the Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems, which **will protect farmers' seed rights, the diversity of indigenous seeds and traditional knowledge.**
- **(iv) BRICS AgriN (Agro Input, Genetic Resources and Information Network):** The fourth initiative is the BRICS AgriN. This will **strengthen cooperation among member countries in areas of agricultural inputs, seeds and genetic resources.**

#### BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network

- 1. The BRICS Urbanisation Forum concluded in Delhi. **The Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal said the BRICS countries had accepted India's proposal to set up a BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network.**
- 2. The Network has been designed as a Chairship-led, institutionally connected platform **to provide a practical and sustained mechanism for urban cooperation within BRICS.**





- 3. It will support systematic knowledge-sharing and mutual learning, while helping bridge the gap between policy and implementation through the exchange of practical solutions, city-level experiences and operational lessons.

### 32. Dinesh Trivedi has recently been appointed as India's:

दिनेश त्रिवेदी को हाल ही में भारत का नियुक्त किया गया है:

- (a) Ambassador to Nepal
- (b) High Commissioner to Bangladesh
- (c) Ambassador to Sri Lanka
- (d) High Commissioner to Maldives

Answer: (b)

### India Appoints Dinesh Trivedi as High Commissioner to Bangladesh

- India appointed Dinesh Trivedi as High Commissioner to Bangladesh

**He became the first political appointee to an ambassadorial post in South Asia in more than three decades.**

- The High Commissioner is the head of a diplomatic mission in a Commonwealth country



### 33. The Ministry of AYUSH recently created a Guinness World Record with how many verified viewers for the "Most Viewers for a YouTube Live Yoga Stream"?

आयुष मंत्रालय ने हाल ही में "यूट्यूब लाइव योग स्ट्रीम के लिए सर्वाधिक दर्शकों" के लिए कितने सत्यापित दर्शकों के साथ गिनीज वर्ल्ड रिकॉर्ड बनाया है?

- (a) 2,46,252
- (b) 3,35,831
- (c) 4,35,831
- (d) 5,35,831

Answer: (c)

### New Guinness World Record set by Ministry of Ayush for most viewers for YouTube Live Yoga Stream

- The International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026, the Ministry of Ayush created a new Guinness World Record for the Most Viewers for a YouTube Live Yoga Stream, with 4,35,831 viewers joining a special global online Yoga session streamed live through the official Ministry of Ayush YouTube channel.**
- The Ministry of Ayush recorded 4,35,831 verified viewers, **surpassing** the previous Guinness World **Record** of 2,46,252 viewers set in **2024**.



### 34. Project Hinichi, recently seen in the news, is primarily associated with:

प्रोजेक्ट हिनिची, जो हाल ही में समाचारों में देखा गया, मुख्य रूप से संबंधित है:

- A. Promoting organic tea cultivation in Northeast India
- B. Replacing illicit poppy cultivation with alternative crops
- C. Expanding bamboo-based industries in tribal areas
- D. Promoting millet cultivation in drought-prone regions

Answer: B

### First green pea harvest completed under Project Hinichi in Manipur

- The first harvest of green peas under Project Hinichi has been successfully completed in Manipur's Churachandpur district.
- **The project has successfully transformed 254 acres of land previously used for illicit poppy cultivation**, and more than 124 households across the district have benefited from the initiative.
- The alternative cropping initiative was launched in April this year under Project Hinichi by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)



### 35. Sarinda, recently granted a Geographical Indication (GI) tag, belongs to which state?

सरिंडा, जिन्हें हाल ही में भौगोलिक संकेत (जीआई) टैग दिया गया है, किस राज्य से संबंधित है?

- A. Assam
- B. Manipur
- C. Tripura
- D. Mizoram

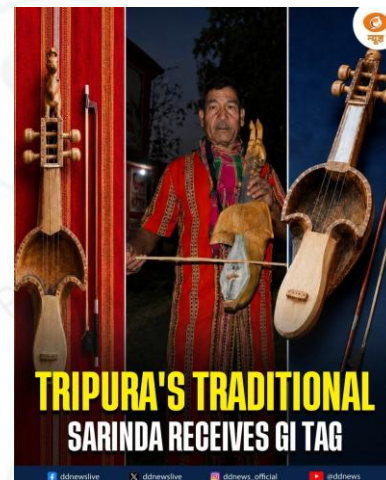
Answer: C

### Tripura's traditional Sarinda receives GI tag

- With the latest addition, Tripura now has four GI-tagged products.
- **Tripura Sarinda is the traditional bowed string musical instrument that is widely used in the folk music traditions of the state's tribal communities.**
- It is handcrafted from a single block of wood and it features a hollow resonator that produces the its distinctive sound.

### Tripura's previously recognized GI products includes the,

- Tripura Queen Pineapple
- Risha/Pachra (Rignai), the traditional attire of indigenous tribal communities
- Matabari Peda ; Tripura Sarinda



### 36. The MEPRO X6 telescopic sight, recently selected by the Indian Army, is manufactured by which country's firm?

हाल ही में भारतीय सेना द्वारा चयनित MEPRO X6 टेलीस्कोपिक दृष्टि, किस देश की फर्म द्वारा निर्मित है?

- A. France
- B. Israel
- C. Germany
- D. United States

Answer: B



### Army Clears Indigenous Production of MEPRO X6 Sights

- The Indian Army has selected Israeli firm Meprolight's MEPRO X6 telescopic sight as **the dedicated daytime optic for its in-service NEGEV 7.62×51 light machine gun (LMG).**
- The **programme involves indigenous manufacture in India under a Transfer of Technology agreement between Meprolight and RRP Defense**, with Bharat Electronics Limited as the prime contractor.
- These sights, with a range of 800 metres as specified by the Army.
- **The MEPRO X6 is a fixed 6x magnification telescopic sight designed for assault rifles, light machine guns and other weapon systems that require a combination of precision, ruggedness and high optical performance.**
- In August 2024, the Army had ordered 41,000 NEGEVs to replace the ageing 5.56x45mm INSAS light machine guns.



### 37. Recently, the Prime Minister of India was conferred with the Order of the White Double Cross, First Class, the highest state honour of which country?

हाल ही में, भारत के प्रधानमंत्री को किस देश के सर्वोच्च राजकीय सम्मान 'ऑर्डर ऑफ़ द व्हाइट डबल क्रॉस, फर्स्ट क्लास' से सम्मानित किया गया?

- (a) Slovenia
- (b) Slovakia
- (c) Serbia
- (d) Croatia

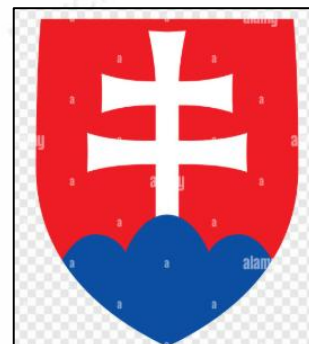
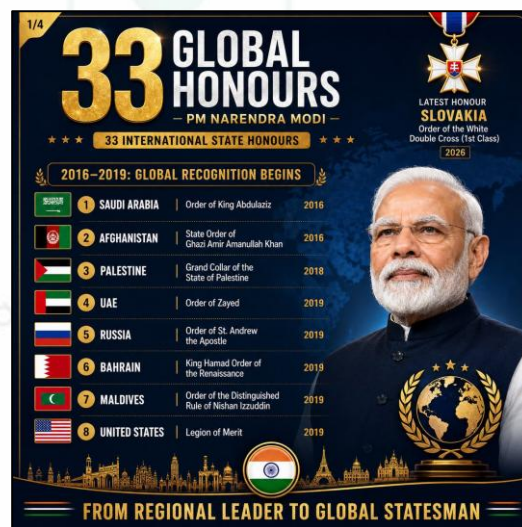
Answer: (b)

### PM Modi Receives Slovakia's Order of the White Double Cross

- **Prime Minister of India was formally conferred with The Order of the White Double Cross, First Class, the highest state honor of the Slovak Republic.**
- The Order of the White Double Cross (Slovak: Rad Bieleho dvojkríža) is the **highest state decoration awarded by the Slovak Republic.**
- This is **Prime Minister Modi's 33rd international honour.**
- Bratislava is the capital of Slovakia and the venue of the award ceremony.

### Peter Pellegrini is the President of Slovakia.

- The Order of the White Double Cross was established after Slovakia became an independent republic in 1993.
- It is awarded by the President of Slovakia and is **primarily given to foreign citizens for their contribution to developing friendly relations with the country.**
- The award takes its name from the white double cross, a historic symbol that forms part of Slovakia's national emblem.





**38. Consider the following countries:**

Italy  
Canada  
South Korea  
Brazil  
United Kingdom

**How many of the above is/are members of the G7?**

- (a) Two
- (b) Three
- (c) Four
- (d) Five

Answer: (b)

**The 52nd G7 Summit**

- Prime Minister of India arrived in Evian, France, to participate in the 52nd G7 Summit at the official invitation of French President Emmanuel Macron.
- It marks India's 13th overall and seventh consecutive appearance as an invitee.
- **The G7 (Group of Seven) Summit is an annual international forum that brings together the leaders of the world's most advanced industrialized economies.**
- It serves as a critical platform for high-level political and economic coordination to shape global responses to pressing transnational challenges.

**Host Details:**

- **Current Host (2026):** Evian, France is hosting the 52nd iteration from June 15-17, 2026, under the presidency of Emmanuel Macron.
- **Next Year's Host (2027):** The rotating presidency will officially hand over to the United States.

**Members of the G7:**

- The G7 comprises seven major advanced industrialized economies, along with the European Union as a participating member: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, United Kingdom, United States.
- **The European Union participates as a fully integrated non-enumerated member.**
- **Invited Guest Countries for 2026 summit:** India, China, South Korea, Kenya and Brazil.

**39. Which Indian sportsperson has been named in TIME magazine's 100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026 list?**

किस भारतीय खिलाड़ी को TIME पत्रिका की खेल 2026 की 100 सबसे प्रभावशाली लोगों की सूची में नामित किया गया है?

- (a) Smriti Mandhana
- (b) P.V. Sindhu
- (c) Harmanpreet Kaur
- (d) Mirabai Chanu

Answer: (A)



### Smriti Mandhana only Indian among TIME magazine's 100 most influential sportspersons

- Cricketer Smriti Mandhana has been named by TIME magazine among this year's 100 most influential people in sports, the only Indian to be featured on the list.
- In 2024, she set the record for most international runs across formats by a woman and then beat her own record last year— "a feat that contributed to her being crowned BBC Indian Sportswoman of 2025."
- TIME's list of the 100 Most Influential People in Sports 2026 features athletes, coaches, advocates and investors who are "people shaping sports today."
- The list, headlined by American basketball legend LeBron James, includes superstars from the world of sports such as football icon Lionel Messi, Chinese-American skier Eileen Gu, tennis star Carlos Alcaraz, basketball player Victor Wembanyama, legendary golfer Rory McIlroy among others.



### 40. Consider the following statements regarding Usutu Virus (USUV):

It is a mosquito-borne flavivirus.

Blackbirds are particularly vulnerable to the disease.

The virus derives its name from a river in southern Africa.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

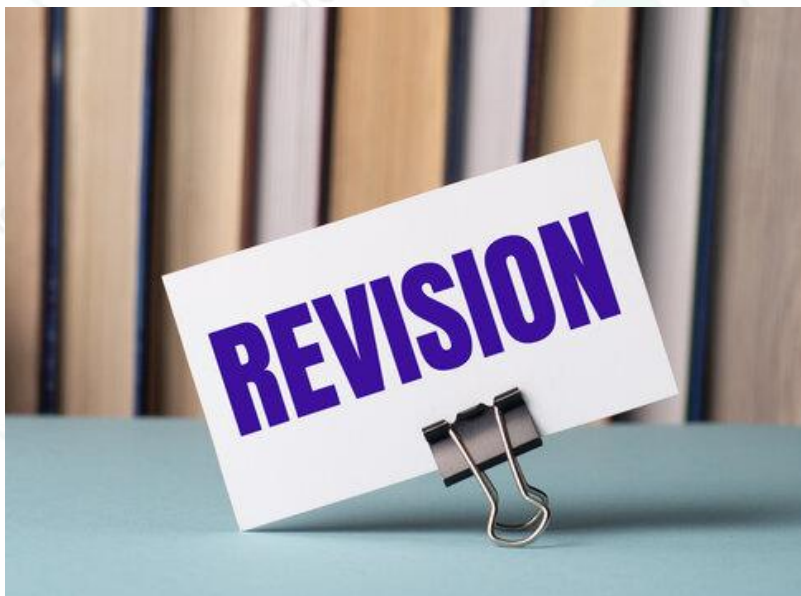
- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

### Usutu Virus Detected in Scotland for First Time

**Usutu virus (USUV), a mosquito-borne flavivirus, was identified in blackbirds in Scotland for the first time in summer.**

- Usutu virus is a mosquito-borne flavivirus **that mainly affects wild birds.**
- Blackbirds are among the most affected bird species in Usutu virus outbreaks.
- **Named after a river in southern Africa** near where it was first identified in 1959,
- The **culex pipiens mosquitoes that carry Usutu are most active and abundant in warm conditions around 25°C**
- The virus is transmitted when an infected mosquito bites a person or animal.



### Appointments

- Vinay Kumar, currently serving as Director in the Ministry of External Affairs, has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to the Democratic Republic of São Tome and Principe.
- The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) appointed senior diplomat Rudra Gaurav Shresth, currently India's Ambassador to Iran, as the country's next Ambassador to Turkiye
- President Donald Trump nominated Jay Clayton, the U.S. attorney for the Southern District of New York and a former Securities and Exchange Commission chairman, as director of national intelligence.
- Former Army officer Dan Jarvis was named Britain's new Defence Minister, hours after John Healey quit.
- The Central government has nominated Sanjay Lohiya, Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance, as a Director on the Central Board of Reserve Bank of India and State Bank of India with immediate effect and until further orders.
- The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved the appointment of Dinesh Pant, as Member (Actuary), and Girija Subramanian, as Member (Distribution) of the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai).
- NBA Reconstitutes Agrobiodiversity Expert Committee, Dr P L Gautam Named Chair
- The Government has appointed Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth, PVSM, UYSM, AVSM, presently serving as the Vice Chief of the Army Staff, as the next Chief of the Army Staff with effect from the afternoon of June 30, 2026.
- The Government has appointed noted economist Professor Alakh N. Sharma as Chairman of a High-Level Technical Expert Committee on Labour Statistics.

### AWARDS

- The Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026 was awarded to Sudarsan Pattnaik during the II International Festival of Sand Sculpture which was held in Russia.

### Obituary

- Lieutenant General Vijay Oberoi, the former Vice Chief of Army Staff, passed away at the Chandigarh Army Hospital aged 84.
- Thailand's Princess Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol, who had been in a coma for more than three years, died.
- Renowned Indian shooting coach and former Asian Games gold medallist Jaspal Rana, 49, passed away.



**BOOKS**

- Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book “Agatthiyar – The Unifier” at the Vice President's House (Uprashtrapati Bhavan) in New Delhi.
- Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu unveiled the book ‘CBN@361 Degrees: Polymath’ at an event organised by the Kakatiya Cultural Association in Singapore.
- A Room in Bombay: A Memoir (HarperCollins India), By Novelist and mathematics professor, Manil Suri

**National**

- The Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (DoSJE) being the nodal Department for drug demand reduction is celebrating “International Day against Drug Abuse & Illicit Trafficking” on 26th June 2026.
- Union Home Minister announced that the government aims to completely withdraw the Armed Forces Special Powers Act (AFSPA) from the majority of the Northeast by next year, as 80 percent of the region is already free from the act.
- The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) under the Department of Consumer Affairs has released a new Indian Standard, IS 20201:2026, aimed at strengthening the management of Community Seed Banks (CSBs) and promoting the conservation of indigenous crop varieties across the country.
- The National Testing Agency (NTA) has launched Pariksha Karmayogi: Capacity-Building Programme for Examination Officials on the iGOT Karmayogi Bharat platform to strengthen the supervision, invigilation, and overall conduct of its examinations.
- Recently, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), in collaboration with the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC), convened a Consumer Packaged Goods (CPG) Roundtable and discussed DigiDukaan.
- The government issued a notification mandating that all syrups, including those used to treat coughs, will now require a doctor's prescription before they can be purchased.
- India has temporarily blocked the Telegram app over concerns it may be used for cheating, days before a crucial medical entrance exam is set to be reheld.

**State**

- Ashok Leyland and Switch Mobility become the first OEMs to provide discounts under the scheme for replacement of old trucks and buses in Delhi-NCR
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh has approved the establishment of a 250 MW Solar Power Project in Sitapur, Uttar Pradesh.
- The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) accelerates the deployment of technologies in Kusunpur, a remote village in Odisha's Kendrapara district, as part of the 'Smart Village' initiative, residents may soon receive alerts whenever crocodiles stray dangerously close to their homes.
- The Maharashtra Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, has officially approved the establishment of a ₹300-crore High-Energy Medical Cyclotron Project (HEMCP) in Nagpur.
- “Operation Tiger” is the codename for an alleged political maneuver by Maharashtra Chief Minister Eknath Shinde's faction to engineer a split within Uddhav Thackeray's Shiv Sena (UBT).
- The BMC recently proposed appointing infrastructure consultancy firm AECOM Asia Company Limited to prepare a comprehensive redevelopment plan for a stretch of Powai Lake along Adi Shankaracharya Marg at a consultancy cost of Rs 1.85 crore.
- Maharashtra Krishna Valley Development Corporation recently issued the Letter of Award (LoA) to a joint venture involving Mumbai-based infrastructure company Patel Engineering Ltd (PEL) for an irrigation project under the Tasgaon Lift Irrigation Scheme in Maharashtra.
- The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) Shri Pralhad Joshi will host the Global Wind Day 2026 Conference on 15th June 2026 in Goa,

- Nearly 60 kg of suspected ganja was seized from the Ernakulam Rural police limits in less than two weeks after the launch of 'Operation Toofan: The Narco Hunt', Kerala Police State-wide anti-drug mission.

### Defence

- The Indian Naval Air Squadron 330, known as "The Harpoons", was number plated after 55 years of service.
- INS Agray is the fifth ship of the Arnala class of Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC) for the Indian Navy.
- An Indian Air Force (IAF) AN-32 transport aircraft crashed and caught fire at the Air Force Station in Assam's Jorhat recently, killing five personnel.
- The Indian Army has introduced Army Uniforms-2026, a revised dress regulations pamphlet that progressively removes residual colonial-era practices, terminology and non-essential accoutrements.
- The National Defence Academy in Pune, the first batch of 17 women cadets trained at the NDA was commissioned
- The government recently decided to build a new Rs 13,000-crore greenfield civil-military airport as part of the Great Nicobar project instead of expanding the existing naval airfield at INS Baaz.

### Science & tech

- Recently, researchers from Mumbai, Kochi, and Japan used the GRAPES-3 telescope to track how the earth's upper atmosphere temperature and the sun's magnetic field affect muons — subatomic particles from space.
- The United States recently activated SOLAR-1, its first dedicated space weather monitoring satellite, designed to provide faster warnings of solar storms that can affect GPS, communications, satellites and power grids.
- Recently, more cases of shigellosis (bacillary dysentery) are being reported across Kerala. It is a highly contagious bacterial diarrhoeal disease caused by shigella.
- Recently, the Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras) has released the world's most detailed 3D Atlas of human brainstem called ANCHOR.
- India's AI ambitions received a major boost, as Bengaluru-based Sarvam announced a fresh \$234 million funding round, pushing its valuation to \$1.5 billion and making it India's newest AI unicorn.

### Environment

- The United Nations carbon market officially issued its first-ever carbon credits under Article 6.4 of the Paris Agreement for a clean-cooking project in Myanmar.
- Telangana officially issued a Government Order banning the sale, distribution, manufacture, and use of the highly toxic weedicide Paraquat to protect farmers and public health.
- Large flocks of migratory flamingos have turned the coastal salt pans of Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu, into a vibrant feeding and resting habitat.
- Lesser Flamingo (*Phoeniconaias minor*): Globally classified as Near Threatened (IUCN Red List).
- Greater Flamingo (*Phoeniconaias minor*): Classified under Least Concern (IUCN Red List).
- A new study published in Science has reported the first global map of the earth's vast underground network of arbuscular mycorrhizal (AM) fungi.
- Recently, the Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve has released the first scientific assessment report on the greater hog badger (*Arctonyx collaris*).
- The first-ever video footage of a herd of the elusive Mishmi Takin have been recently recorded in the Tingda Reserve Forest of North Sikkim.

- The governments of India and Japan officially adopted the 'Rules of Implementation' for the Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM).

### Index & Reports

- A new global climate assessment released during the Bonn Climate Change Conference (SB64), 2026 warns that all major planetary climate indicators have worsened since the last IPCC assessment cycle.
- The International Institutional Ranking Framework (IIRF) has released its list of the top 10 government universities in India for 2026. At the top of the list is Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) in New Delhi, followed by the University of Delhi (DU) at second place. Jamia Millia Islamia, also located in Delhi, holds the third position.
- Jimmy Donaldson, popular as MrBeast, has become the first YouTuber to surpass 500 million subscribers on the video-streaming platform.
- A new UNICEF Children's Climate Risk Report 2026 has revealed that nearly 392 million children in India (92% of all children) are exposed to extreme heat, while 89 million face recurrent heatwaves.

### International

- India launched Unified Payments Interface (UPI) at Galeries Lafayette, a famous department store in Nice, France.
- The India-France ATL Bridge was officially established during the Bharat Innovates 2026 summit in Nice, France.
- The United States Department of War announced that the US Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM) will officially restore its name to the US Pacific Command (USPACOM).
- The United States and Iran officially announced a breakthrough preliminary peace agreement to immediately end their military conflict and completely lift the naval blockade on the strategic Strait of Hormuz and the Gulf of Oman.

### Sports

- India's overall tally at the Ulaanbaatar Open - 16 Medals included eight golds - three each in men's and women's freestyle and two in Greco-Roman wrestling.
- New Zealand icon and former skipper Kane Williamson has announced his retirement from international cricket.
- The 23rd edition of the FIFA World Cup—the 2026 tournament—officially kicked off on June 11, 2026, marking the start of a historic 39-day international men's soccer championship.
- Lewis Hamilton secured his historic first victory for Scuderia Ferrari at the 2026 Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix.

### Banking / finance

- In a first-of-its-kind initiative Reserve Bank of India (RBI), has launched RBI Reelathon 2026, a state-wide mass awareness campaign targeting college students to combat the growing menace of cyber-enabled financial frauds.

### QUESTION OF THE DAY

'Swadha', recently seen in the news, is a:

हाल ही में खबरों में रही 'स्वधा' क्या है?

- (a) Khadi export promotion scheme
- (b) Wellness wear collection
- (c) Yoga certification programme
- (d) Handloom marketing portal



